Appendix 2. Newcastle-Ottawa Scale for longitudinal articles

Note: A study can be awarded a maximum of one star for each numbered item within the Selection and Outcome categories. A maximum of two stars can be given for Comparability

Selection

1) Representativeness of the exposed cohort
a) truly representative of the average PIM/PPO users (older adults ≥ 65) in the community, hospital or aged care facility **– 1**
b) somewhat representative of the average PIM/PPO users (older adults ≥ 65) in the community, hospital or aged care facility **- 1**
c) selected group of users eg nurses, volunteers
d) no description of the derivation of the cohort

2) Selection of the non exposed cohort
a) drawn from the same community, hospital or aged care facility as the exposed cohort **- 1**
b) drawn from a different source
c) no description of the derivation of the non exposed cohort

3) Ascertainment of exposure
a) secure record (eg surgical records) **- 1**
b) structured interview **- 1**
c) written self report
d) no description

4) Demonstration that outcome of interest was not present at start of study
a) yes **- 1**
b) no

Comparability

1) Comparability of cohorts on the basis of the design or analysis
a) study controls for comorbidities **- 1**
b) study controls for polypharmacy **- 1**

Outcome

1) Assessment of outcome
a) independent blind assessment **- 1**
b) record linkage **- 1**
c) self report
d) no description

2) Was follow-up long enough for outcomes to occur
a) yes (2 weeks) **- 1**
b) no

3) Adequacy of follow up of cohorts
a) complete follow up - all subjects accounted for **- 1**
b) subjects lost to follow up unlikely to introduce bias - small number lost - > 20% **- 1**
c) follow up rate < 50% and no description of those lost
d) no statement